COURSE · MODULE 04

Module 04 · Lifecycle, gates and funnel

How an initiative moves forward, what a gate can decide and why the portfolio is managed like a sales funnel

Fernando García Varela Version 0.1 (working draft) 19-09-2026 Draft for review

25	8	5	2
minutes	phases, from 0 to 7	possible outcomes of a gate	iterations before the decision is escalated

IN THIS DOCUMENT

01 Objective

02 Key ideas

03 Guided tour

04 Exercise

05 Self-check

06 Next step

Legal notice and disclaimer. SEVEN-G is a reference methodological framework provided "as is" and for information purposes only. It does not constitute legal, regulatory, financial or professional advice, nor does it guarantee compliance with any law or standard. References to general regulation (such as the EU AI Act, the GDPR, DORA or NIS2), to technical standards and to regulation specific to each sector or jurisdiction may be incomplete, may not apply to a particular case or may become out of date as a result of regulatory changes, interpretations or supervisory positions after their consultation date. **Each organisation that uses SEVEN-G is solely responsible for identifying the regulation that applies to it, verifying that it is current and certifying its own regulatory compliance**, with the appropriate qualified advice. This methodology is a generic, free aid shared with the community so that nobody has to start from scratch; each person or organisation can and should adapt it to its own use. It must not be inferred that its legally sensitive parts have been reviewed by legal counsel: those reviews, for each company or sector, are the ultimate responsibility of the company, consultant or organisation that uses it. Although every effort is made to keep it up to date, some regulation may have changed without being reflected here. To the fullest extent permitted by law, the author accepts no responsibility whatsoever for the effects of its application in any organisation or for its full applicability. The methodology does not grant certification of any kind. The author accepts no liability for any use made of this content or for any decisions taken on the basis of it. The data, figures, companies and cases in the examples are fictitious or illustrative.

01

Objective

By the end you will be able to say which phase an initiative is in, what it is asked for to pass its gate, what the competent body can decide and how the portfolio is read in the initiative register.

02

Key ideas

1. **Eight phases and a gate at the end of each.** In phase 6 (operation) the gate is a periodic continuity review, R6.
2. **Dual validation.** A gate checks both the result and the documentation. Without verified evidence there is no decision.
3. **Five outcomes**: proceed, proceed with conditions, iterate, pivot or stop. At G7: scale, iterate or retire. **Stopping is a good outcome** when it avoids building something unfeasible; G3 is the main stop gate.

4. **The portfolio is a funnel.** As in sales, stages, times, requirements and loss reasons are recorded. Unlike sales, the aim is not to convert more, but to decide well.

03

Guided tour

Step	What to open	What to look at
1	document 01, section 6.1	The table of phases with the question each one answers.
2	document 01, section 7	How a gate works, the outcomes and who verifies and decides.
3	document 21, section 6.4	The G3 criteria: code, evidence, obligation and Lite or Enterprise column.
4	document 04, section 4	What is taken from sales funnel management and where the framework departs from it.
5	document 03, sections 3.5 and 3.6	Funnel metrics and reference time limits per phase.
6	T01, funnel, board and gates views	The example portfolio by phase, time in phase and the status of each criterion.

04

Exercise

In the example register (T01):

1. Click a bar of the funnel to filter the initiatives in that phase. Which one has been in its phase the longest?
2. Open IA-2025-004 (screening of job applications). At which gate was it stopped, for what reason and what was learnt?
3. Open IA-2025-005. It was not stopped: it was retired after being in use. Why?
4. Open the example board dashboard (T17) and find those two cases in the funnel exit cards.

05

Self-check

1. What two things does dual validation check?
2. What happens if an initiative iterates twice at the same gate?
3. Can "proceed with conditions" be approved on a security criterion marked "Yes ◆"?
4. Is a 100% conversion at every gate a good sign?

06

Next step

Module 05 · Governance and risk · Course guide

Answers. 1) The result (what the data or tests demonstrate) and the documentation (that the evidence exists, is valid and is verified). 2) The third decision is taken by the higher body. 3) No: those criteria are never accepted as a condition. 4) No: it points to soft gates or to a portfolio that only admits safe bets.